

The \$100M Line: Appendix

Methodology, definitions, assumptions, limitations and sources for *The \$100M Line*, Edition 2.1. Data as of September 2026. Published by FastTrackr Research, October 2026. This appendix is a separate document and is not counted in the 12-page report.

Disclosure: FastTrackr provides transition and re-papering software to advisers and may benefit from the transitions described in the report.

A1. Evidence tiers

Every number in the report carries one of four tiers.

TIER	WHAT IT IS	HOW IT IS USED
T1	FastTrackr's own analysis of public SEC Form ADV data	Basis for every count and dollar amount
T2	FastTrackr operating knowledge (transition taxonomy)	Which documents each type of move needs
T3	Primary public statements: Fidelity's letter and spokesperson as quoted, custodian and platform releases, pricing pages, executive statements	Facts about the announcement, prices, minimums and courting
T4	Third-party estimates (Winthrop & Co., Cerulli, recruiters)	Cross-checks and footnotes only; never headlines

A2. Data and dates

- SEC investment adviser roster, `ia09012026.zip`, dated 2026-09-01.
- IAPD state compilation feed, `IA_FIRM_STATE_Feed_10_01_2026.xml.gz`, dated 2026-10-01 (8,919 state firms in the universe). The 2026-10-02 feed is used only for the large-firm supplement.
- Schedule D 5.K(3) custodian names and amounts, parsed from IAPD Form ADV PDFs for the 16,332 universe firms, and for 18,601 firms in a full scan that adds SEC firms with \$1B or more. Dataset frozen 2026-10-05.

Fields used. Item 5D (individual and high-net-worth clients), Item 5F (regulatory assets under management, RAUM), Item 5A (employees), Item 5.K(4) (separately managed accounts with a custodian), Schedule D 5.K(3) (custodian name and amount), main office state, SEC and state registration dates, and Item 7A affiliations (context only).

A3. Universe and definitions

STEP	FIRMS
Registered investment advisers (SEC roster plus state feed; 166 on both counted once)	33,321
Serve retail clients (Item 5D individuals or high-net-worth > 0)	22,240
Report a custodian for separately managed accounts (Item 5.K(4) = Yes)	18,599
Study universe: all state-registered firms plus SEC firms with RAUM under \$1B	16,332
List Fidelity in Schedule D 5.K(3)	2,286 (1,570 SEC, 716 state)
Affected: under \$100M held at Fidelity	1,087 (400 SEC, 687 state), \$40.5B at Fidelity

Report terms and their technical equivalents:

REPORT TERM	DEFINITION
Affected firm	Lists Fidelity in Schedule D 5.K(3) with less than \$100M held there

REPORT TERM	DEFINITION
Small firms (under \$100M in total)	Segment A: firm RAUM < \$100M. 708 firms, \$20.8B at Fidelity, ~52,000 clients, median Fidelity share 99%
Larger firms with a small Fidelity slice	Segment B: firm RAUM ≥ \$100M but < \$100M at Fidelity. 379 firms, \$19.7B at Fidelity, ~103,000 clients, median Fidelity share 25%
Fidelity-only firms	No other custodian listed at 10% or more. 393 firms: 349 in Segment A (\$15.7B), 44 in Segment B (\$2.3B)
Firms that already use a second custodian	"Has-other": at least one other custodian listed. 694 firms
Fidelity share	\$ at Fidelity ÷ total \$ across all custodians the firm lists in 5.K(3)
Largest other custodian	The non-Fidelity custodian with the highest reported \$ in 5.K(3). Schwab is largest for 480 (226 in A, 254 in B); 541 affected firms list Schwab at any amount (256 in A, 285 in B)
Choice firms	Has-other firms whose combined custodied total is ≥ \$100M: 307 firms (306 in Segment B), \$16.4B at Fidelity and \$66.2B elsewhere, \$49.9B of it at Schwab
Assets under management	RAUM, Item 5F

A4. Large-firm supplement

The 10% visibility test in 5.K(3) applies to separately managed account assets, not total RAUM, so firms of \$1B or more can be affected. A full scan of 18,601 firms finds 39 SEC firms with \$1B or more (~\$1.86B at Fidelity, median Fidelity share about 7%, 2 Fidelity-only) and one state firm that appears only in the 2026-10-02 feed. With these 40 firms, the all-firm total is 1,127 firms, \$42.4B at Fidelity and 395 Fidelity-only firms. The headline stays at 1,087 / \$40.5B (firms under \$1B), because the flow and workload models cover that group.

A5. Registration cohorts

For state firms, registration year is the earliest approved state registration. For SEC firms it is the earliest of the SEC effective date, any state approval, and a year implied by the firm's CRD number, which is issued in sequence. This corrects for firms that moved from state to SEC registration and would otherwise look new; it moves 1,334 SEC firms out of the 2024–26 cohort. The CRD mapping is tight (about ±1 year) for CRD numbers above 280,000.

Small-firm cohorts (RAUM < \$100M): ≤2021 n = 6,472; 2022–23 n = 1,163; 2024–26 n = 1,445. Shares of each cohort listing a custodian: Schwab 66.3% → 64.7%; Altruist 9.5% → 22.1% (Altruist and Vanguard combined 11.0% → 22.7%); Interactive Brokers 13.9% → 9.3%; Fidelity 8.5% → 6.2%; SEI 2.3% → 1.5%; Betterment 1.9% → 1.9%.

A6. Custodian names

Names are normalized: all SEI entities to SEI; MTG, LLC to Betterment Securities; Folio Investments and Goldman Sachs to Goldman Sachs Advisor Solutions; AssetMark, TradePMR, Wells Fargo (First Clearing) and Merrill entities consolidated. Altruist and Vanguard are combined as one destination, "Altruist (Vanguard)", because Vanguard's purchase of Altruist (announced 2026-08-26) is pending. Betterment is shown in the custodian table but is not a modeled destination, because of its asset-based repricing effective 2027-01-01 and the absence of a recruiting statement.

A7. Flow model assumptions (all Estimated)

Each firm is split into probabilities across move types and destinations that sum to one. Firm counts in flow figures are expected values. Four scenarios are run: Base, Network-heavy, Low/Savvy and Consolidate into Fidelity. The headline "\$33–39B leaves" is the range across all four (\$32.8–38.7B, 81–95%).

#	ASSUMPTION	LOW / BASE / HIGH	TIER
A1	Share of Fidelity-only firms that join a larger firm or are acquired	5% / 12% / 20%	Assumption; anchored on T4 context
A2	Same, has-other firms	2% / 4% / 8%	Assumption

#	ASSUMPTION	LOW / BASE / HIGH	TIER
A3	Joiners whose host keeps Fidelity (the rest go to Schwab-custodying hosts)	60% / 65% / 70%	Assumption; T3 platform ADVs, T4 (Winthrop "Option 4")
A4	Has-other firms consolidate into their largest other custodian	Fixed	User decision on T1 data
A5	Base-case destinations for Fidelity-only firms: Schwab, Altruist (Vanguard), Interactive Brokers, SEI, Goldman Sachs Advisor Solutions	Fixed	T1 cohorts; T3 courting shown, not used as a filter
A6	Destination weights = share of the 2024–26 small-firm cohort (n = 1,445)	65.7% / 23.0% / 9.5% / 1.5% / 0.3%	T1
A7	Eligibility: destination's published minimum $\leq$ firm's size band	No minimum binds; Goldman's minimum is not disclosed and assumed eligible	T3
A8	Network-heavy: remaining has-other firms that switch custodian	10%	Assumption
A9	Low/Savvy: remaining Fidelity-only firms with $\geq$ \$25M at Fidelity that use Savvy	10% / 12.5% / 15%	Assumption; T3 Savvy launch
A10	Betterment is not a destination; 7 has-other firms (\$0.10B) stay with it	Fixed	User decision
A11	4 has-other firms whose largest other is Vanguard fold into Altruist (Vanguard)	Fixed	User decision
A12	Closures, retirements and timing are not modeled	Scope	—
A13	Consolidate into Fidelity: eligible majority-Fidelity firms (55) that move assets in	60%	Assumption
A14	Consolidate into Fidelity: other eligible firms (252)	10% / 15% / 25%	Assumption

SCENARIO RESULTS (ESTIMATED).

SCENARIO	LEAVES FIDELITY	STAYS ON FIDELITY RAILS	TO SCHWAB (DIRECT + HOST)
Base	~\$38.5B (95%)	~\$2.0B	~\$27.0B
Network-heavy	~\$37.0B (91%)	~\$3.5B	~\$25.1B
Low / Savvy	~\$37.6B (93%)	~\$2.9B	~\$26.2B
Consolidate into Fidelity	~\$34.1B (84%)	~\$6.4B	~\$23.8B
Range across scenarios	~\$32.8–38.7B	~\$1.8–7.6B	~\$23.8–27.0B

Base-case destinations: Schwab direct ~\$25.9B (64%; ~\$15.5B of it from firms already custodying there), Altruist (Vanguard) ~\$4.3B, other existing custodians ~\$4.6B (long tail ~\$3.2B; Raymond James, Axos, Pershing, LPL and AssetMark ~\$1.4B), Fidelity via a host firm ~\$2.0B, Interactive Brokers ~\$2.0B, Schwab via a host firm ~\$1.1B, SEI ~\$0.6B, Goldman Sachs Advisor Solutions under \$0.1B. In the Consolidate-into-Fidelity scenario, ~68 firms stay and ~\$10.5B moves into Fidelity (range \$7.4–16.7B). That assumes full consolidation; firms that move only enough to clear \$100M would bring in about \$2.4B. Savvy, if Fidelity confirms the route and onboarding opens in time, keeps ~\$1.6–2.4B on Fidelity clearing.

A8. Workload assumptions (all Estimated)

#	ASSUMPTION	LOW / BASE / HIGH	TIER
W1	Clients = Item 5D individuals + high-net-worth	154,987 (observed)	T1
W2	Clients in scope: all clients for Fidelity-only firms; scaled by Fidelity's share of custodied \$ for has-other firms	67,252 scoped clients	T1 inputs; Assumption
W3	Clients per household	1.3 / 1.15 / 1.0	Assumption
W4	Accounts per household	2.0 / 2.5 / 3.0	Assumption
W5	Beneficiary or servicing forms per re-custodied account	0.5 / 1.0 / 1.5	Assumption; T2 taxonomy \$14.2(b)

#	ASSUMPTION	LOW / BASE / HIGH	TIER
W6a	Consolidate into an existing custodian: account opening + transfer (ACAT) per account; no new firm paperwork	~2 per account	T2 taxonomy \$14
W6b	Open a new custodian: one custodial-relationship pack per firm + account opening + servicing forms + ACAT per account	~3 per account + 1 per firm	T2 taxonomy \$14.2(b)
W6c	Join a host that keeps Fidelity: change-of-advisor form per account + advisory agreement, fee schedule, Form CRS, privacy notice per household	1 per account + 4 per household	T2 taxonomy \$14.1, \$14.2(a)
W6d	Join a host at Schwab: re-custody forms per account + 4 firm documents per household	Heaviest per household	T2 taxonomy \$14.1, \$14.2(b)
W6e	Savvy introducing-broker route: treated like re-custody	~3 per account	Assumption (Savvy account documents not published)
W7	Signature-required documents: all custodian forms, advisory agreement, fee schedule, firm agreement; Form CRS and privacy notice delivered, not signed	—	Assumption
W8	Client touches per household	Consolidate 2; re-custody or Savvy 3; join keeping Fidelity 3; join to a Schwab host 4	Assumption

Base-case results. ~58,000 households, ~146,000 accounts, ~376,000 documents (range 244,000–564,000) and ~151,000 client touches (range 133,000–173,000). Upper bound if every client of every affected firm is re-papered: ~768,000 documents. By move type: open a new custodian ~204,000; consolidate ~133,000; join a host keeping Fidelity ~20,000; join a Schwab host ~19,000. Small Fidelity-only firms are 32% of affected firms, 39% of the dollars and ~48% of the documents.

A9. Persona method

Jordan and Riley are composite firms built from Form ADV medians. They are not real firms. Each is a band of affected firms; every descriptive figure is the band median (T1), and workload uses the base-case assumptions in A8 (script `scripts/ws7_personas.py`, output `data/ws7_personas.csv`).

	JORDAN, THE \$50M SOLO PLANNER	RILEY, THE LARGER FIRM WITH A SMALL FIDELITY SLICE
Band	Fidelity-only affected firms with \$40–60M under management	Segment B has-other firms whose largest other custodian is Schwab
Firms in band	75 (67 state-registered; 56 with two or fewer employees; \$3.45B at Fidelity)	254
Median assets under management	~\$50M	~\$212M
Median at Fidelity	~\$48M (100% of custodied assets)	~\$49M (21%)
Median at largest other custodian	—	~\$135M at Schwab
Median employees	1	5
Median clients	59	~168 (~33 behind the Fidelity slice)
Move type used	Open a new custodian	Consolidate into Schwab
Households / accounts (base)	~51 / ~128	~29 / ~72
Documents, base (low–high)	~386 (228–620)	~145 (102–200)
Client touches (base)	~154	~58

Jordan's nine-month timeline is illustrative. Every date except the June 30, 2027 deadline is an assumption. The signature pace (about five households a week from early March to mid-May) is derived from ~51 households over that window.

A10. Limitations

1. **The 10% floor.** Schedule D 5.K(3) lists only custodians holding 10% or more of separately managed account RAUM. A firm with a small Fidelity sleeve can be invisible, so 1,087 is a floor. A firm we call Fidelity-only may have a small second custodian; for the 44 larger Fidelity-only firms, a median 31% of RAUM is at Fidelity and the rest sits in places Schedule D does not itemize.
2. **Amendment vintage.** Amounts are as of each firm's most recent annual amendment, so some are up to a year old.
3. **Anomalies kept, not dropped.** 20 affected firms report more at Fidelity than in RAUM (2 by more than 50%); 12 report Fidelity with \$0; 13 report RAUM under \$1M; one employee count is an obvious typo. Medians and means exclude \$0 Fidelity amounts and use cleaned employee counts. Where a firm lists two Fidelity entities, amounts are summed.
4. **Modeled figures.** All flows and workload are Estimated and depend on the assumptions in A7 and A8.
5. **Not modeled.** Firm closures and retirements, moves before or after the deadline, client attrition during transitions, and any change Fidelity may make to the policy.
6. **Facts pending verification.** Several custodian facts come from search-engine extracts of custodians' own pages, which blocked direct access: Altruist's "no AUM minimums" statement and transition-team claims; Interactive Brokers' fee and transfer-fee statements; Goldman Sachs Advisor Solutions' description of the firms it serves; LPL's removal of its hybrid-RIA minimum; Raymond James' "freedom from minimums" language. Altruist's chief executive's statement is known through trade-press reports of a LinkedIn post. Platform minimums for Integrated Advisors Network (2014) and Carson Partners are dated. Savvy's \$25M figure comes from a recruiting job posting.

A11. Third-party cross-checks (T4)

- Winthrop & Co. (2026-10-02) estimates ~1,100 affected firms and ~385 Fidelity-only firms from the same filings. Our independent counts are 1,087 and 393 (1,127 and 395 including larger firms).
- Winthrop's "Option 4" (joining a host that keeps Fidelity) informs the A3 range.
- A Cerulli estimate that clients take about 19% of assets elsewhere when an advisor changes custodian (2021, as cited by TradePMR) is context only and is not used in any figure.
- Cerulli figures on network affiliation, used as context for A1, come from a search extract and are unverified.
- Our Item 7A affiliation rates are context only; the A1–A2 range is a fixed assumption.

A12. Rounding

Observed counts are exact. Dollars are rounded to \$0.1B, percentages to whole numbers unless shown otherwise, and workload figures to the nearest hundred or thousand. Estimated figures carry "~" and appear as ranges where the range matters.

B. Sources

All URLs accessed or confirmed between 2026-10-01 and 2026-10-05 unless a date is shown. B1–B6 are the sources cited in the report and this appendix. B7 lists further sources consulted during research (from the project source index), deduplicated against B1–B6.

B1. SEC DATA (T1)

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